

Tesla Cybercab

The **Tesla Cybercab** is an upcoming two-passenger battery-electric self-driving car under development by Tesla. The vehicle is planned to be fully autonomous. The prototype vehicles have no steering wheel or pedals. The Tesla Cybercab is part of the Tesla Robotaxi service.

A concept version of the Cybercab was unveiled in October 2024, with 20 prototypes providing short rides to attendees of the announcement event. Tesla reports production is planned to commence in April 2026.

History

Background

In 2019, Tesla CEO Elon Musk stated that he believed that Tesla would have one million autonomous robotaxis operating on public roads by the end of 2020; observers speculated that he meant converting already sold Tesla vehicles to be autonomous.^[1]

Since approximately 2020, Tesla has made public statements about a mass market electric car product that would follow the Model Y^[2] and would be considerably cheaper than the Model 3. In 2022, Musk was advocating inside the company that the robotaxi would be Tesla's next vehicle, but by September 2022, he had reluctantly accepted the recommendation of Tesla executives Franz von Holzhausen and Lars Moravy that the next-generation vehicle platform should support both a small, inexpensive, mass-market car and a robotaxi that would be built with no steering wheel at all, and that both could be manufactured on the platform and use the same next-generation vehicle assembly line.^[3] In October 2022, the company stated publicly that the Tesla engineering team had turned its focus to the new platform, and that the company expected the platform would enable cars to be half of the price of the Tesla Model 3 or Y.^[4]

In April 2024, Musk announced that the Robotaxi reveal would take place in August, subsequently delayed to October.^[5]



Cybercab on display, November 2024

Overview	
Manufacturer	<u>Tesla, Inc.</u>
Production	2026 – present
Assembly	<u>Gigafactory Texas</u>
Designer	<u>Franz von Holzhausen</u>
Body and chassis	
Body style	2-door <u>coupe</u>
Powertrain	
Battery	35 <u>kWh</u>
Electric range	~200 mi (320 km)

Announcement

Musk unveiled the Cybercab at the Tesla *We, Robot* event held October 10, 2024, at Warner Bros. Studios Burbank in California, where 20 concept Cybercabs were autonomously driving around the studio outlot at night and giving rides to attendees of the event.^{[6][7]} Musk stated that Tesla intends to produce the Cybercab before 2027.^[8] The final name of the vehicle remains unclear, as Tesla used both "Robotaxi" and "Cybercab" throughout the event to refer to the cars.^[6] Tesla also demonstrated their humanoid robot, Optimus, at the event and showed off a single concept prototype of a Robovan that could reportedly hold as many as 20 passengers.^[9]



Rear view of the Tesla Cybercab at unveiling

The concept Cybercab shown was a two-passenger car,^[10] it had two butterfly doors but no door handles as the doors opened automatically. The car had a hatchback opening for cargo, with no external charge port showing on the prototype vehicles. The car had no rear window and no side view mirrors.^{[11][12]}

The production vehicle design will include inductive charging.^{[6][13]}

Investor reaction to the announcement was muted, particularly given the long time frame between the announcement and expected start of production.^[8] New Scientist noted the Cybercab will not be available for two years while the Waymo self-driving cars are operating on streets today.^[14]

In October 2024, Alcon Entertainment, a production company that worked on Blade Runner 2049 (2017), sued Musk for apparent similarities between Tesla's marketing of the Cybercab and the film.^[15]

Production

On the Tesla investor call on October 23, 2024, Tesla said they were aiming to be in volume production with Cybercab by the end of 2026, and that the annual production goal was 2 million Cybercabs per year, when several factories are at full design capacity.

In November 2025 at the Shareholder meeting, Elon Musk announced that the Cybercab production will begin in Q2 2026.^[16]

In February 2026, Tesla announced the first Cybercab production vehicle had been produced at the Gigafactory Texas.^[17]

Design

Cybercab is designed to be a two-passenger car.^[9] It is planned to support only autonomous operation: neither steering wheel nor pedals will be accessible to passengers. The range is planned to be 200 mi (320 km).^[18] It will support inductive charging^[6] with planned efficiency above 90%. Battery capacity is 35 kWh.^[18] Tesla reports efficiency of 5.5 mi/kWh (8.9 km/kWh)^[18]

Roof

The roof is made of polyurethane panels with embedded pigmentation. The roof is not painted during manufacturing. Plastic parts are welded ultrasonically. An extended headliner matches the frameless windows. Roof-mounted sensors are not present.^{[19][20]}

References

1. Ford, Martin (September 18, 2021). "Elon Musk's failed Tesla robotaxi promise is the height of self-driving hype" (<https://www.fastcompany.com/90677822/elon-musks-tesla-robotaxi-promise-typifies-self-driving-overexuberance>). *Fast Company*. Retrieved April 10, 2024. "At the [2019 Autonomy Day] event, Musk said, 'I feel very confident predicting autonomous robotaxis for Tesla next year.' He went on to suggest that Tesla would have a million such cars operating on public roads by the end of 2020. By 'robotaxis,' Musk meant genuine self-driving cars, capable of operating with no one inside and able to pick up passengers and deliver them to random locations. In other words, a truly robotic version of Uber or Lyft."
2. Morris, James (March 4, 2023). "Tesla Investor Day 2023: \$25,000 Next Gen Vehicle To Be Made In Mexico" (<https://www.forbes.com/sites/jamesmorris/2023/03/04/tesla-investor-day-2023-25000-next-gen-vehicle-to-be-made-in-mexico/>). *Forbes*. Retrieved October 10, 2024.
3. Isaacson, Walter (September 12, 2023). *Elon Musk* (<https://www.simonandschuster.com/books/Elon-Musk/Walter-Isaacson/9781982181284>). Simon & Schuster. pp. 501–505. ISBN 978-1-982181-28-4. Retrieved November 28, 2023.
4. Lambert, Fred (March 2023). "Tesla is working on next-gen electric car platform for half the price" (<https://electrek.co/2022/10/20/tesla-next-gen-electric-car-platform-half-price/>). *Electrek*. Retrieved October 10, 2024.
5. "Tesla Delays Robotaxi Event in Blow to Musk's Autonomy Drive" (<https://www.bloomberg.com/news/articles/2024-07-11/tesla-plans-to-delay-robotaxi-unveiling-to-october-from-august>). *Bloomberg*. July 11, 2024.



Interior front of Cybercab



Side view of the Cybercab

6. Schroeder, Stan (October 11, 2024). "Tesla's 'Cybercab' robotaxi is here, and yet still so far away" (<https://www.yahoo.com/tech/teslas-cybercab-robotaxi-yet-still-072131923.html>). *Mashable*. Retrieved October 11, 2024 – via Yahoo Tech. "Cybercab (or Robotaxi — the name isn't entirely clear right now as both names were used throughout the event)"
7. Aarian, Marshall (October 9, 2024). "Tesla Is Ready to Roll Out Its Robotaxis" (<https://www.wired.com/story/tesla-is-ready-to-roll-out-cybercab-robotaxi/>). *Wired*. Retrieved October 9, 2024.
8. "Musk Shows Tesla Cybercab, Sees Sub-\$30,000 Cost and 2026 Production" (<https://www.msn.com/en-us/autos/other/musk-shows-tesla-cybercab-sees-sub-30000-cost-and-2026-production/ar-AA1s4ROh>). *Bloomberg News*. October 11, 2024. Retrieved October 11, 2024.
9. "Tesla's robovan is the surprise of the night" (<https://www.theverge.com/2024/10/10/24267158/tesla-van-robotaxi-autonomous-price-release-date>). *The Verge*. October 11, 2024. Retrieved October 11, 2024.
10. Hawkins, Andrew J. (October 11, 2024). "Tesla Cybercab announced: Elon Musk's robotaxi is finally here" (<https://www.theverge.com/2024/10/10/24265530/tesla-robotaxi-elon-musk-features-range-price-release-date>). *The Verge*. Retrieved October 14, 2024.
11. Anderson, Brad (October 10, 2024). "Tesla Cybercab Is A \$30,000 Robotaxi Without A Steering Wheel Or Pedals" (<https://www.carscoops.com/2024/10/tesla-cybercab-is-a-robotaxi-youll-be-able-to-buy-for-less-than-30000/>). *Carscoops*. Retrieved October 14, 2024.
12. "Tesla Cybercab Robotaxi unveiled: 5 insane highlights" (<https://auto.hindustantimes.com/auto/electric-vehicles/tesla-cybercab-robotaxi-unveiled-5-big-highlights-41728626594804.html>). *HT Auto*. October 11, 2024. Retrieved October 14, 2024.
13. Forlini, Emily Dreibelbis (October 11, 2024). "Tesla's Robotaxi Event: Mostly Fluff, Except for One Interesting Technical Detail" (<https://au.pcmag.com/cars-auto/107741/teslas-robotaxi-event-mostly-fluff-except-for-one-interesting-technical-detail>). *PCMag Australia*. ISSN 1329-3532 (<https://search.worldcat.org/issn/1329-3532>).
14. "Elon Musk's Tesla Cybercab is a hollow promise of a robotaxi future" (<https://www.newscientist.com/article/2451547-elon-musks-tesla-cybercab-is-a-hollow-promise-of-a-robotaxi-future/>). *New Scientist*. October 11, 2024. Retrieved October 11, 2024.
15. Barnes, Brooks (October 21, 2024). "'Blade Runner 2049' Producers Sue Elon Musk Over 'Robotaxi' Imagery" (<https://www.nytimes.com/2024/10/21/business/media/elon-musk-alcon-entertainment-robotaxi-lawsuit.html>). *The New York Times*. ISSN 0362-4331 (<https://search.worldcat.org/issn/0362-4331>). Retrieved February 13, 2025.
16. Alvarez, Simon (November 7, 2025). "Tesla Cybercab production starts Q2 2026, Elon Musk confirms" (<https://www.teslarati.com/tesla-cybercab-production-starts-q2-2026-elon-musk-confirms/>).
17. Lambert, Fred (February 17, 2026). "Tesla rolls first steering wheel-less Cybercab unit off the line before solving autonomy" (<https://electrek.co/2026/02/17/tesla-rolls-first-steering-wheel-less-cybercab-unit-off-the-line-before-solving-autonomy/>). Retrieved March 10, 2026.
18. "Tesla's Cybercab Wireless Charging Video May Tell Us A Lot" (<https://insideevs.com/news/737986/cybercab-wireless-charging-video-tesla/>). *Inside EVs*. October 18, 2024. Retrieved October 24, 2024.
19. Aregay, Tinsae (February 24, 2025). "Tesla Confirms the Cyber Cab will Feature Plastic Body Panels & Will Not Require Painting. Instead, the Color Will be Injected While Molding the Polyurethane Panels – 'No More Orange Peel or Paint Bleed' | Torque News" (<https://www.torquenews.com/11826/tesla-confirms-cyber-cab-will-feature-plastic-body-panels-will-not-require-painting-instead>). *www.torquenews.com*. Retrieved December 17, 2025.
20. FutureAzA (February 25, 2025). *The REAL Reason Tesla's Cybercab Is Going Plastic – It's GENIUS* (<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IFYvbZaK8fs>). Retrieved December 17, 2025 – via YouTube.

